
22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

30 August 2026

Welcome Back

After the summer break, it is good to be back with our weekly reflection and the Gospel this Sunday is a great place to restart.

Last week we heard Peter's great confession: "*You are the Christ.*" This week, only moments later in the same conversation, the same Peter gets it badly wrong. Jesus speaks of the cross, and Peter takes him aside to talk him out of it. "*Get behind me, Satan,*" Jesus replies. Peter, the rock, has become a stumbling block!

There is great comfort in that. Peter is not a baddie here; he is a man who loves Jesus and cannot bear the thought of him suffering. His mistake is one we all make: wanting God on our terms, wanting faith without cost, wanting the crown without the cross.

Jesus does not reject Peter. He simply tells him to get back where a disciple belongs: behind the Master, following, not leading.

Jeremiah knew the same struggle. In the first reading he complains that God has seduced him, that being a prophet has brought him nothing but insult and derision. He decides to say no more and then finds a fire burning in his heart that he cannot hold in. Faith is like that. It costs, and yet we cannot walk away from it, because it is life itself.

"Anyone who loses his life for my sake will find it." As a new school and parish year begins, that is the question the Gospel puts to each of us: where am I spending my life? On things that will pass, or on the One who lasts?

Welcome back and every blessing as we continue our journeys. May we find life by giving it away for God.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £2483.00; **Sion Mills:** £1135.00. Thank you. Sunday 12 July: **Melmount:** £3234.00; **Sion Mills:** £1206.00. Thank you.

Sunday 19 July: Thank you for your contributions to the Priest Collection.

Sunday 26 July: **Melmount:** £2859.00; **Sion Mills:** £1291.00. Thank you.

Sunday 2 August: **Melmount:** £3353.00; **Sion Mills:** £1050.00. Thank you.

Sunday 9 August: **Melmount:** £2373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1076.00. Thank you.

Sunday 16 August: **Melmount:** £2595.00; **Sion Mills:** £1320.00. Thank you.

Fr. Sean would like to thank you all for your continued support.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 31 August after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Cait Cooke, Oliver Terence Coyle Burrows, Max Dean Harkin, Mia Jean Hoynes

Lochlan Eamon Sweeney, Logan Samuel Warden, Adi Bobjee Gary McKearney

Darragh Stephen Kearney, Leo Naoise McCrossan, Wren Kerri McLaughlin

Amelia Patricia Turnbull, Ava Michelle Turnbull, Ada Helen Mullen

Amelia Bernadette McDonnell, Cian Thomas Martin, Blaine Michael Kelly

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Terry McGonigle, 59 Carrick Strand

Pat Quinn, 24 Ashgrove Park

Frank Connolly, 1 Glebe Park

Anthony McGillian, 23 Innisfree Gardens

Garvan O'Connor, 35 Castlegrange Park

Jane O'Friel, Lifford

Michael Boyce, Laurel Drive

Michael (Mixer) McCrossan, 4 Marian Park

John Duncan, 18 Church View

Harry Mullen, 300 Victoria Road

Charlie Gillespie, 33 Belldoo

Laurence Gallagher, 16 Drumman Court

Maureen Duffy, 32 Ballycolman Road

Tommy Curley, Lisnafin Park

Margaret Sweeney, 66 Glebe Gardens

Leo O'Kane, Wicklow, formerly Bridge Street

Speedy Rouse, 22 Upper Main Street

Anniversaries

Columba O'Neill, Thomas James Devlin, Gerard Kearney

Annie Mary Elliott, Liam Corry, Danny Carlin

Mark McGrath, Geraldine McBrearty, Damien McGrath

Tony McAleer, Ruby Duffy, Raymond Allen, Sheila McHugh

Willie Christy, Joe McShane, Owen Sweeney

Willie Doyle, Pearl McAneny, Aidan Callaghan

Arthur O'Kane, Paddy Connolly, Dymphna Coyle

First Friday Friday of this week is the First Friday. Mass will be at 10.00am in St. Mary's, Melmount. Confessions will take place there on the Thursday before the First Friday after 10.00am Mass and on Friday after 10.00am Mass (*if no funeral*). Mass in St. Theresa's, Sion Mills at 7.00pm on the First Friday.

Vocations We pray that the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Leukaemia & Lymphoma NI Our Strabane Branch's Annual Walk for Blood Cancer Awareness Month will take place on Friday 4 September leaving from MK's Bar, Derry Road at 7.00pm. You can register on the night from 6.30pm or pre-book your place at:
<https://lni.co.uk/event/strabane-walk-for-blood-cancer-awareness-month/>

Holy Cross College will reopen for pupils as follows:

Tuesday 1 September – Year 8 and Peer Mentors

Wednesday 2 September – Years 8, 12, 13 & 14

Thursday 3 September – Years 9, 10, 11, 12, 13 & 14

Friday 4 September – All Year Groups

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly *The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust* and *The Irish Pilgrimage Trust*) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details email:
Info@Catholicmothers.ie

Season of Creation 2026 The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This year's theme '*Living Water*' invites us to give thanks for the gift of water.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station to present the donation to the RNLI. ***Please Note:*** *Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St. Patrick's Church, Dungiven at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.*

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.